

HTML Learning Notes

A complete reference guide based on your first HTML file

1. Document Structure Tags

`<!DOCTYPE html>`

Not a tag — it's a declaration. Tells the browser this is an HTML5 document. Must always be the very first line of the file.

`<html> ... </html>`

The root element. Every other tag goes inside this. It wraps the entire webpage.

...

`<head> ... </head>`

Contains hidden metadata — information about the page that is NOT displayed to the user (title, styles, links).

My Page

`<title> ... </title>`

Sets the text shown on the browser tab and in bookmarks. Goes inside `<head>`. In your file: 'My First File'.

My First File

`<body> ... </body>`

Contains everything visible on the webpage — text, headings, images, links. All visible content goes here.

Hello

2. Heading Tags `<h1>` to `<h6>`

HTML has 6 levels of headings. **h1** is the largest and most important; **h6** is the smallest. Your file uses h1, h2, h3, and h4 — all displaying 'Hello'.

Tag	Size	Use for
<code><h1></code>	Largest	Main page title (use only once per page)
<code><h2></code>	2nd	Major section headings
<code><h3></code>	3rd	Sub-sections
<code><h4></code>	4th	Smaller sub-sections
<code><h5></code>	5th	Rarely used

<code><h6></code>	Smallest	Rarely used
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3. Text Formatting Tags

`<p> ... </p>` – Paragraph

Wraps a block of text as a paragraph. Browsers automatically add space above and below each paragraph.

Welcome to the lecture.

`<b> ... </b>` – Bold (Visual only)

Makes text visually bold. No semantic meaning — just a style change. Screen readers treat it the same as normal text.

Welcome → Welcome (bold)

`<i> ... </i>` – Italic (Visual only)

Makes text visually italic. Like `<b>`, it has no special meaning — purely for appearance.

Welcome → Welcome (italic)

`<strong> ... </strong>` – Strong Importance

Makes text bold AND tells the browser/screen readers this content is IMPORTANT. Prefer this over `<b>` in real projects.

dolor → dolor (bold + important)

`<em> ... </em>` – Emphasis

Makes text italic AND signals emphasis to screen readers. The semantic version of `<i>`. Prefer this over `<i>`.

Lorem ipsum... → italic + emphasized

`<sub> ... </sub>` – Subscript

Lowers text below the baseline. Used for chemical formulas (H₂O), math, footnotes.

Welcome_{to} → 'to' appears smaller below the line

`<sup> ... </sup>` – Superscript

Raises text above the baseline. Used for ordinals (1st), math exponents, footnotes.

1st → 'st' appears smaller above the line

`<hr>` – Horizontal Rule

Draws a horizontal dividing line across the page. Self-closing — no closing tag needed. Used to separate content visually.

→ draws a line (used inside your paragraphs)

4. Semantic & Special Tags

<blockquote cite='URL'> – Block Quotation

Used for a long quote taken from an external source. The cite attribute holds the URL of the original source (not shown to users — for machines/SEO). Browsers indent blockquotes by default.

Pakistan, officially the Islamic Republic...

<abbr title='full text'> – Abbreviation

Marks an abbreviation or acronym. The title attribute shows the full expanded form when the user hovers over it. Note: your code has a typo — 'languange' should be 'language'.

HTML

5. HTML Entities

Some characters have special meaning in HTML (like < and >). To display them as text, use entity codes. Your file uses ** ** twice.

Entity Code	Displays as	Use for
 	(space)	Non-breaking space (used in your file)
<	<	Less-than sign
>	>	Greater-than sign
&	&	Ampersand character
©	©	Copyright symbol

6. Semantic vs Visual Tags — Key Difference

This is one of the most important concepts in HTML. Two tags can look identical in the browser but have very different meaning:

Tag	Visual Effect	Has Meaning?	Prefer in Real Projects?
	Bold text	No — styling only	No
	Bold text	Yes — marks importance	Yes ✓
<i>	Italic text	No — styling only	No
	Italic text	Yes — marks emphasis	Yes ✓

7. Tips & Common Mistakes

Always close your tags. Every opening tag like <p> needs a closing </p> (except self-closing tags like <hr> and
).

Indent nested tags for readability — it makes your code easier to read and debug.

Use only ONE <h1> per page — it is the main title. Use h2, h3 etc. for sub-sections.

Prefer over and over <i> — semantic tags improve accessibility and SEO.

TYPO in your file: title='hyper text markup language' — 'language' should be 'language'.

Avoid using <hr> inside inline text like or <i> — use it between block elements like paragraphs.

The <title> tag goes inside <head>, not <body>. It controls the browser tab, not the page heading.

Happy coding! Keep practicing by building more HTML files. ■